

# **BEYOND THE KINGDOM**

Episode #0006

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Story Day: Friday, January 7, 2005, 10:39 PM – Monday,  
January 10, 2005, 11:02 PM EST

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room  
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0006

(ages as of Monday, January 10, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68)

THE OLSONS: MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) · GRACE BULLOCK (20)

THE SMILLEYS: ODESSA SMILLEY (84) · LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIANNE SMILLEY (49) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22)

THE CHILDREN: EMMA SMILLEY (2) · VICTORIA SMILLEY (2) · LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22)

THE SEVEN: TOBIAS "THE LEDGER" OKAFOR (24) · KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25) · ROMAN GAINES (28) · DOLORES "MAMA DEE" WHITFIELD (53) · RASHAD "SAINT" MAYFIELD (23)

RECURRING: CAMILLE RHODES (38) · SPECIAL AGENT KATHLEEN "KATE" DOYLE (34) · SPECIAL AGENT DANIEL "DANNY" REYES (29) · SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57) · RUBY MAE "NANA RUBY" TOLLIVER (66) · BEATRIX "NANNY BEA" PENNINGTON (43) · THADDEUS CROWE (40) · BRIELLE SUTTON (21)

INTRODUCING: INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47), Fulton County DA's Office, Cold Case Unit

DAY PLAYERS: BERNICE WHITLOCK (Lamar's widow) · REVEREND OSCAR PEAVY (Greater Cascade Baptist) · KEYONNA (7) · DEANDRE (9) · NURSE TONYA · APD EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN · NATHANIEL GREER (Director of Global Security, Donohue Hotels & Resorts, by phone) · DONNA KEEL · MERRIWEATHER NEPHEW (TEDDY)

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Joan Donohue (Manor) · the person on the other end of Martin's call · Alvin Donohue (Miami) · Darnell "Dee" Divine · Desmond Smilley

FADE IN:

TEASER

**1 EXT. NORTHSIDE DRIVE NW – THE CURVE – NIGHT**

*Friday, January 7, 2005 – 10:39 PM EST*

Black trees. A two-lane road that bends hard to the left above a wooded ravine. One streetlight, a hundred yards back, that doesn't reach this far. A steel guardrail, newer than the road, bolted in sometime in the last three years.

ARIANNA's silver BMW sits on the gravel shoulder with its engine running and its headlights pointed straight at the curve.

The driver's door is open.

ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) stands at the guardrail in her stocking feet. No coat. Her hands are flat on the cold steel. She's staring down into the dark.

Headlights sweep around the bend behind her. An ASTON MARTIN DB9 brakes hard, tires chewing gravel, and stops nose-to-tail with the BMW.

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) is out before the engine is off. He's in a gray sweatshirt and jeans, no jacket, exactly what he was wearing when the phone rang.

MARC

Ari.

She doesn't turn.

MARC (CONT'D)

I told you not to get out of the car.

ARIANNA

(to the ravine)

They put a guardrail up.

MARC

(coming closer, slow,  
the way you walk up on  
a spooked horse)

Spring of '02. The county did a study.

ARIANNA

A study.  
(a terrible little  
laugh)  
A study said this curve was  
dangerous.

MARC

Ari. Look at me.

ARIANNA

They're going to put his picture  
up in my office, Marc. The  
investigator. That's how she  
works. She said so. She puts the  
picture on the wall so she never  
forgets whose case it is.  
(beat)  
I'm going to have to look at him  
every day.

MARC

Look at me.

She finally turns. Her face is wrecked, wet, and blank at  
the same time. Mascara. Blue ink still in the lines of her  
right palm from the pen she snapped Thursday.

He takes her face in both his hands.

MARC (CONT'D)

(low and absolutely  
steady)  
I will handle this.  
(beat)  
I've always handled this.

ARIANNA

You handled HIM.  
(beat)  
Who handles her? Who handles  
Harmony? She thanked me, Marc. On  
the internet. She thanked me in  
front of the whole world.

MARC

(beat)  
Me.

He pulls her into his arms. She breaks against his chest,  
a sound coming out of her that's barely human, three years  
deep.

He holds her. His eyes are open over her shoulder, fixed on the guardrail, the ravine, the dark.

WIDE: two small figures in the headlights at the edge of a curve that the county made safer too late.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES — "KINGDOM"



**ACT ONE****2 EXT. GREATER CASCADE BAPTIST CHURCH – CASCADE ROAD – DAY**

*Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 10:51 AM EST*

A cold, brilliant Saturday. A red-brick church with a white steeple on Cascade Road, Southwest Atlanta. A MERRIWEATHER & SONS hearse, black and polished to a mirror, idles at the curb with its back door open.

On the church steps, something Atlanta has never seen.

On the LEFT side of the steps, twenty MERRIWEATHER MEN in black suits and black overcoats. Old heads and young ones. Silas's people.

On the RIGHT side, twenty BLACKWATER MEN in charcoal suits and charcoal overcoats. Saint's people. SAINT MAYFIELD (23) stands at the top, hands folded in front of him like an usher.

They don't look at each other. They don't have to. They stand shoulder to shoulder down both rails of the stairs, making an aisle for the widow.

Church mothers in wide black hats pass between them, staring.

ACROSS THE STREET – ELXA'S UNMARKED CROWN VICTORIA

CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24), in a black wool coat over plain clothes, sits behind the wheel. DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) is in the passenger seat with a paper cup of coffee going cold in his hand.

JEREMY

I've been a cop four years. I've never seen that.

ELXA

Nobody's seen that. Merriweather and whoever the hell that is on the right, standing on the same steps. In 1994, those two families would've shot each other over a parking space.

JEREMY

That's not a truce. That's a press release.

ELXA  
(watching Saint)  
It's a statement.

JEREMY  
Saying what?

ELXA  
That neither one of them did it.  
(beat)  
And that they want whoever did to  
see them standing together.

Jeremy follows her eyeline down the block. A dark-blue Ford Taurus with government plates is parked at the corner.

JEREMY  
Company.

In the Taurus: SPECIAL AGENT KATE DOYLE (34) behind the wheel, and SPECIAL AGENT DANNY REYES (29) with a long-lens camera, shooting through the windshield. CLICK. CLICK. CLICK.

ELXA  
(not surprised)  
The FBI photographs funerals. Of  
course it does.

The church bells begin to ring.

A black Cadillac pulls up behind the hearse. The driver opens the rear door.

SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57), in a black cashmere coat and a gray homburg, steps out. Two fingers of his left hand are crooked. Old breaks, badly set.

He turns and offers that hand, the crooked one, back into the car.

MAMA DEE WHITFIELD (53), in a black church suit and a black hat with a small veil, takes it and steps out.

On the steps, every man on both sides straightens.

Elxa leans forward.

ELXA (CONT'D)  
(quietly)  
Who is that?

JEREMY

Dolores Whitfield. Dee's Kitchen.  
Best smothered chicken on the  
West Side.

In the Taurus, Reyes lowers the camera.

REYES

(to Doyle)

The lady with the veil. Both  
sides straightened up for her.

DOYLE

I saw.

REYES

Somebody's mother?

DOYLE

(writing on a legal  
pad: "DEE'S KITCHEN -  
WHITFIELD")

Somebody's somebody.

CUT TO:

**3 INT. GREATER CASCADE BAPTIST CHURCH – FELLOWSHIP HALL  
– DAY**

*Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 1:22 PM EST*

After the burial. The repast. Long folding tables with white paper tablecloths, church ladies behind steam pans of fried chicken, green beans, macaroni and cheese, and pound cake. The room is full and loud. Grief turning into eating, the way it does.

BERNICE WHITLOCK (40s), Lamar's widow, sits at the head table in black. People bend to hold her hands. She is dry-eyed, exhausted, and holding a plate she hasn't touched.

Across the hall, near the coffee urn, Mama Dee and Silas stand side by side, each holding a paper cup. They are the calmest two people in the room.

SILAS

Friday night came and went,  
Dolores.

MAMA DEE

I know what day it is.

SILAS

Your boy promised proof by  
Friday. I got a coin with the  
wrong number of waves on it and  
your word.

MAMA DEE

You got more than that. You got  
the shooter's van burned up in  
Clayton County with a church's  
plates on it. You got two men  
dead who never paid a dime to  
anybody but you and us. And you  
got my word.

(beat)

My word used to be enough for  
you.

SILAS

(beat)

Your word was always enough for  
me. It's his I've never heard.

MAMA DEE

You're hearing it through me.  
That's how it works.

Silas looks across the hall. Saint stands at the back  
wall, arms folded, watching everything. A young  
MERRIWEATHER NEPHEW, TEDDY (20s), sharp-dressed and  
restless, stands at the opposite wall, staring right back  
at Saint.

SILAS

(nodding at Teddy)

My sister's boy. Theodore. They  
call him Teddy.

(beat)

Teddy thinks your people killed a  
deacon and a loan man to scare  
us, and he thinks I'm old for  
letting it slide. He's got  
friends that think so too.

MAMA DEE

And what do you think?

SILAS

I think Earl Tuggle owed me four thousand dollars from 1985, and I never once asked him for it, because he came to my wife's wake and stood in the rain for two hours.

(beat)

And I think somebody wants me to think what Teddy thinks. That's what I think.

MAMA DEE

Then keep Teddy on a leash.

SILAS

I'll keep him as long as I can keep him.

(beat)

Tell your boy I'm going to be patient. But tell him it's a Merriweather kind of patience. It runs out on a Tuesday, it doesn't say so on a Monday.

He sets down his cup. He crosses to Bernice.

Mama Dee watches him go. Then she catches Saint's eye across the hall and gives him one small nod.

Saint walks to the head table. He bends down and says something quiet to Bernice. He puts a plain white envelope in her hands and closes her fingers over it.

Bernice looks up at him.

BERNICE

Who are you?

SAINT

Nobody, ma'am. A friend of the deacon's.

(beat)

It's the mortgage. Through the end of the year. And the funeral's been paid.

BERNICE

(stunned)

Mr. Merriweather said the funeral was—

SAINT

Mr. Merriweather's a gentleman.  
So he won't mind.

Across the room, Silas sees the envelope. He sees Saint.  
He sees Bernice press it to her chest.

He tips his homburg a half-inch to Saint. Saint nods back.

Teddy sees it too, and his jaw tightens.

CUT TO:

**4 INT. CAMILLE RHODES'S CONDOMINIUM – THE PARK PLACE ON  
PEACHTREE – THE BEDROOM CLOSET – MORNING**

*Saturday, January 8, 2005 – 7:52 AM EST*

Earlier that same Saturday. A thirty-fourth-floor condo,  
all white and glass, with a view straight down Peachtree.

ROBERT BULLOCK (45), in weekend clothes, a quarter-zip and  
driving loafers, stands in the doorway of a walk-in closet  
the size of a studio apartment. He has never once been  
here on a Saturday.

CAMILLE RHODES (38), in a silk robe with her hair down,  
walks past a long rail of women's suits to the end, where  
a man's white dress shirt hangs by itself on a wooden  
hanger. Turnbull & Asser, with French cuffs.

Camille takes it down. She doesn't fold it. She holds it  
out on the hanger.

CAMILLE

She asked.

ROBERT

She asked where it went. I told  
her the car.

CAMILLE

(evenly)

You told Natasha Donohue you left  
a four-hundred-dollar shirt in  
the car for five days.

ROBERT

(beat)

She said she'd look in the car.

A small, sharp smile from Camille.

CAMILLE

Then you'd better put it in the car.

He takes the shirt from her. He's already turning to go.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

Robert.

He stops.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

Six years. You've never once come here on a Saturday.

(beat)

And the first time you do, it's for a shirt.

ROBERT

(quietly)

Camille. Not now.

CAMILLE

It's always "not now." "Not now" is the only time zone I live in.

He looks at her. For a second, the man she fell in love with is in his face: tired, tender, sorry.

ROBERT

I'll call you tonight.

CAMILLE

You won't.

ROBERT

(beat)

I'll call you Monday.

He goes. The front door closes.

Camille stands alone in the enormous closet. She looks at the empty wooden hanger.

Then she looks at the glass bottle on the vanity behind her: a heavy crystal flacon with a gold stopper shaped like a pair of smiling lips. SMILE.

She picks it up. Turns it in the light.

She had five days to wash that shirt.

She didn't.

CUT TO:

**5 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR – MORNING**  
*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 7:31 AM EST*

Monday morning. The pale-yellow parlor where Simone has taken breakfast for forty years. Winter light through old wavy glass. A silver coffee service. Grits, eggs, and a basket of biscuits under a linen napkin.

SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94), in a lavender cashmere twinset and her everyday pearls, sits at the round table with her back perfectly straight.

Marc sits across from her in a navy suit, tie loosened already, his plate full. He looks like he's slept maybe four hours since Friday.

MARC

Gorgeous, I'm telling you. It's not a feud. It's a hostage situation.

SIMONE

Your grandfather is not a hostage. He's a guest in his own library, and he has twenty thousand books to keep him company. All he needs is to stop calling mayors when his wife asks him not to.

(beat)

I sent chamomile.

MARC

Grandma said she asked you for it.

SIMONE

She did.

(beat)

That's the part that matters. When a woman is angry enough to banish a man to the library and still asks her mother-in-law for his tea, the marriage is fine. It's the man who isn't.

Marc smiles into his coffee. Simone watches him over her biscuit.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Saint Mayfield brought your car  
through the Crown Gate at  
one-twenty Saturday morning, and  
you came home in Arianna  
Cummings's automobile at  
eleven-fifteen Friday night.

(beat, pleasantly)

The gatehouse sends me a list. It  
has since 1958. Nobody ever  
remembers.

Marc sets down his coffee.

MARC

Ari had a bad night.

SIMONE

I'm sure she did.

(beat)

That child hasn't looked me in  
the eye in three years.

MARC

She's shy.

SIMONE

Something happened to Arianna  
Cummings the winter after the  
towers came down. Christmas of  
2001 she was at my table.  
Christmas of 2002 she sent a  
card.

MARC

(evenly)

She went to law school, Gorgeous.  
It'll do that.

Simone looks at him for a very long moment. Then she lets  
it go, deliberately, the way she might set down a teacup  
she's decided not to throw.

SIMONE

The Smilley girl.

Marc goes very still.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

The one in red. At your birthday.  
She turned around.

MARC

I heard.

SIMONE

You didn't just hear. You froze the picture.

(off his look)

Officer Hollis's wife sings in my choir.

MARC

(beat, admitting nothing)

She came to the gate twice. Once the morning they moved in, and once in a ball gown. I just want to know why.

SIMONE

(sipping her coffee)

Of course you do.

MARC

Do you know why?

SIMONE

(beat)

I know that when a woman drives to a gate in a red Valentino, and then turns around, she didn't forget something at home.

(setting down her cup)

She remembered something.

Marc looks at her. Simone looks back, bright-eyed, ninety-four and a step ahead.

MARC

Gorgeous. What happened in Savannah?

SIMONE

(smiling)

Not on a Monday.

MARC

You always say that.

SIMONE

And it's always Monday when you ask.

She lifts the linen off the biscuit basket and puts one more on his plate.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Eat. You have sick children to read to.

CUT TO:

**6 INT. BELLE RIVE – THE LAUNDRY ROOM – MORNING**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:07 AM EST*

A big, bright laundry room off the kitchen wing: two washers, two dryers, a pressing station, and a long folding counter under a window onto the frosted back lawn. It smells like starch and Downy.

NANA RUBY TOLLIVER (66), in a housedress and a cardigan, sorts Monday's whites from a wicker hamper into piles with brisk efficiency. The radio plays WAOK. A gospel hour.

NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) appears in the doorway, dressed for the office in an ivory St. John suit, briefcase in hand, on her way out. She says good morning and turns to go. Behind her, Ruby lifts a man's white dress shirt out of the hamper by the shoulders, shakes it out, and hesitates.

Just a second. Just long enough.

Natasha sees the hesitation. She turns back.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

What?

RUBY

(beat)

Nothing, baby.

NATASHA

Ruby.

Ruby looks at the shirt. Then she folds it once over her arm and holds it out.

RUBY

Mr. Robert brought it in out of the Mercedes on Saturday afternoon. Held it up in the kitchen like he'd caught a fish.

(beat)

"See? The car." That's what he  
said. Twice.

Natasha sets down her briefcase. She takes the shirt.

Turnbull & Asser. French cuffs. Robert's monogram on the  
pocket: R.J.B.

She lifts the collar to her face.

Holds it there.

Her eyes close.

Under the starch and the cologne she knows, something  
else. Tuberose. Something green and cool underneath. A  
little vetiver. Warm skin.

NATASHA  
(very quietly, eyes  
still closed)  
Smile.

RUBY  
Ma'am?

NATASHA  
(opening her eyes)  
It's called Smile. Vivienne  
Smilley's perfume. It came out in  
Paris two years ago. Saks started  
carrying it at Phipps in  
December. The bottle looks like a  
pair of lips.  
(beat)  
Four hundred dollars an ounce.  
Robert has never bought a woman a  
four-hundred-dollar bottle of  
anything in his life.  
Five days in a car, Ruby. A shirt  
doesn't keep a woman's perfume  
for five days in a car.  
(beat)  
It keeps it in a closet.

Ruby says nothing. There's nothing to say.

Natasha folds the shirt carefully, perfectly, collar and  
cuffs, the way Joan taught her when she was eight. She  
holds it against her chest.

NATASHA (CONT'D)  
Wash everything else.

RUBY  
And this one?

NATASHA  
This one I'm keeping.

She picks up her briefcase and walks to the door. She stops.

NATASHA (CONT'D)  
(without turning)  
Ruby.

RUBY  
I know.

NATASHA  
You didn't find anything.

RUBY  
(beat, gently)  
Baby, I haven't found anything in  
this house in twenty-five years.

Natasha goes. Ruby stands at the folding table. She looks at the pile of Robert's undershirts.

She turns the radio up. The choir swells.

RUBY (CONT'D)  
(to herself, dropping  
the whites into the  
machine)  
Lord, hold her up. And hold me  
back.

FADE OUT.



**ACT TWO****7 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – MORNING**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:58 AM EST*

The DA's corner office on the fourth floor of the courthouse at 136 Pryor Street. Boxes still half-unpacked from a week ago. A view of the gold dome of the Capitol three blocks away.

Arianna sits at her desk in a charcoal suit, hair pulled back tight, makeup flawless. Nobody looking at her would ever know about Friday night. On the credenza, a vase of white roses from her parents, already drooping.

She picks up the phone and dials.

ARIANNA  
(into phone)  
Chief Jackson, please. It's the  
District Attorney.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S OFFICE – CONTINUOUS**

Elxa at her desk, in uniform, with four stars on each collar point and a mug that says WORLD'S OKAYEST DAUGHTER, a gag gift from Grace. Her office is a converted Sears storeroom and still looks like one.

ELXA  
(into phone)  
Arianna. You got my voicemail.

ARIANNA  
I got it Friday night. I'm sorry.  
I had a family thing.

ELXA  
You never have family things.

ARIANNA  
(beat)  
Two coins, Elxa.

ELXA

Two coins at Big E's. The one in his hand had six crests. The one on the counter behind the register had seven. Thumb-worn. Old. I think it had been sitting in that cash drawer since before I made captain.

ARIANNA

A protection coin.

ELXA

That's my theory. Earl Tuggle paid somebody to leave him alone. The somebody left him a coin. Then somebody ELSE came along and killed him and put a fake in his hand.

(beat)

Whoever's killing these men isn't Blackwater, Ari. It's somebody who wants us to think it's Blackwater.

ARIANNA

(carefully)

Or it's Blackwater, and they're smart enough to plant a fake so you'll think exactly that.

ELXA

The FBI filed for a court order Friday afternoon. For the coins. All of them.

ARIANNA

Judge?

ELXA

Federal magistrate. Carver.

ARIANNA

Then she'll sign it this morning. Carver signs everything before her second cup of coffee. Photograph everything. Every coin, every angle, under the scope. Keep your own chain of custody. When they send it back — and they'll send it back — you'll know if it's the same coin.

ELXA  
(writing)  
Already done. Jeremy did it  
Friday night.

ARIANNA  
Then you're ahead of them.

ELXA  
(beat)  
Arianna. The canary meeting. It's  
still on for Wednesday.

ARIANNA  
Good.

ELXA  
Hughes asked this morning if we  
could move it. Mayor Whitaker's  
budget hearing got pushed to  
Wednesday morning, and all the  
deputy chiefs have to testify.  
He's pushing for Thursday.

ARIANNA  
Then Thursday. It doesn't matter  
what day. It matters what he  
hears.

ELXA  
(quietly)  
If it's him, Ari. If he's the  
leak.

ARIANNA  
Then you'll know in an hour. And  
then you decide what kind of  
chief you are.

A beat on both women.

ELXA  
Thank you. For the canary. It was  
a good idea.

ARIANNA  
It was your idea. I just told you  
it was legal.

Elxa almost smiles. She hangs up.

In the DA's office, Arianna sets down the receiver and  
sits back.

On her desk: the thin brown folder. MP-2002-0014.

She's taken it out of the bottom drawer. She's put it on top of her desk where anyone could see it. She lays her palm flat on the cover.

A KNOCK at her door.

CUT TO:

**8 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – CONTINUOUS**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 9:16 AM EST*

The door opens before Arianna says come in.

INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47) walks in. A small, solid woman in a brown pantsuit that's seen a few years of courtrooms, low heels, and reading glasses on a beaded chain around her neck. She carries a canvas tote bag that says GBI CRIME LAB 1992 FAMILY PICNIC and a steel thermos of her own coffee.

She has a face people tell things to. She knows it.

CARLA

Madam District Attorney. Carla Mims. I'm sorry. I knock and then I walk in. My husband says it's the only rude thing about me.

ARIANNA

(standing, extending  
her hand)

Ms. Mims. Please. Come in. You already have.

CARLA

(shaking her hand, a  
firm, dry grip)

Carla.

ARIANNA

Arianna.

CARLA

No, ma'am. Not in this building. I call the District Attorney "Madam District Attorney." I called Mr. Tate "Mr. District Attorney" right up until the day they took his parking spot away.

She sits without being asked. She opens the thermos, pours coffee into its cap, and sets the canvas bag on the floor.

CARLA (CONT'D)  
I read the Divine file this weekend. All nine days of it.

ARIANNA  
(sitting)  
And?

CARLA  
And it's a disgrace.

ARIANNA  
(evenly)  
What do you need?

CARLA  
Everything. But let me tell you how I work first, so you're not surprised.

She reaches into the canvas bag. She takes out a manila envelope. She slides out a photograph and lays it on the desk.

An 8x10 enlargement of the flyer photo. DARNELL "DEE" DIVINE, age 22. A cap turned backward. A big, easy grin. A gold chain. His arm is thrown over somebody who's been cropped out of the frame.

Arianna doesn't let herself look away from it.

CARLA (CONT'D)  
I put him up. Everywhere I work, I put him up on the wall. So every time I lift my head, I see whose case it is. It's not superstition. It's discipline.  
(beat)  
You mind if I put a copy in here?

ARIANNA  
(beat)  
I don't mind.

CARLA  
Good.

She takes a second copy out of the envelope, stands, and walks it to the corkboard by the window. She pins it up with a red pushpin, right at eye level from Arianna's desk

chair.

Dee grins down at the District Attorney.

Carla sits back down and picks up her coffee.

CARLA (CONT'D)

The file says he left a private party on the 3100 block of Northside Drive at around a quarter to two in the morning. On foot. No car. The party host was a man named Lamont Grier. Dee's cousin's friend. House party, sixty, seventy people, music, a lot of Hennessy.

(beat)

Nobody at Lamont Grier's saw him after he left. Ray asked. That's the one thing Ray did.

ARIANNA

Then where do you start?

CARLA

With everybody else.

(beat)

New Year's Eve on Northside Drive, Madam District Attorney. That's not a street, that's a ballroom. Between West Paces and Moores Mill there are forty houses, and I'd bet my pension on this: that night, six or seven of them were throwing a party.

(beat)

Sixty people at each. Four hundred people. Coming and going on that road between midnight and four in the morning, in cars, with headlights.

Arianna's hand is flat on her desk. Very still.

CARLA (CONT'D)

Somebody saw a young man walking. Somebody always sees. They just never know it mattered.

(beat)

So I want the guest lists. Every private party on Northside Drive between West Paces Ferry and Moores Mill on December 31, 2001.

Caterers, valets, bartenders, the security companies. Rich folks hire all four, and all four keep paper.

ARIANNA

(beat)

That's a lot of doors in a very particular zip code.

CARLA

Yes, ma'am. Rich folks don't love a cold-case investigator on the porch. That's why I need a letter on your letterhead, over your signature, telling them the District Attorney of Fulton County personally asks for their cooperation.

She slides a typed letter across the desk. Arianna's own letterhead. A space at the bottom for a signature.

Arianna reads it. Her eyes stop halfway down the page.

INSERT – THE LETTER: "...all residences hosting private gatherings on Northside Drive NW, between West Paces Ferry Road and Moores Mill Road, on the night of December 31, 2001-January 1, 2002..."

BACK TO SCENE

Arianna looks up. Carla is watching her over the rim of the thermos cap. Kind eyes. Patient eyes.

CARLA (CONT'D)

Something wrong with it?

ARIANNA

(beat)

"Personally" is a strong word.

CARLA

It's supposed to be.

Arianna picks up her pen, a heavy black Montblanc, a gift from her father for her swearing-in.

She signs it.

Arianna Cummings. District Attorney.

She slides it back across the desk.

CARLA (CONT'D)  
(taking it, folding it  
once, sliding it into  
the canvas bag)  
Thank you, Madam District  
Attorney.  
(standing, gathering  
her things)  
I'll call the family this  
afternoon. Mrs. Divine said she'd  
see me any day but Sunday.  
Sunday's church.  
(beat)  
And the sister. Harmony. She's  
the one who didn't let it go.

ARIANNA  
She never let it go.

CARLA  
(at the door)  
The ones who never let it go are  
the reason I have a job.  
(beat)  
Oh. Madam District Attorney. You  
grew up around there. Belmont  
Crest's right off Northside.

ARIANNA  
(beat)  
Yes.

CARLA  
Where were you that New Year's?

A frozen beat.

ARIANNA  
(evenly)  
I was nineteen, Carla. I was at a  
party.  
(beat)  
Like everybody else on Northside  
Drive.

CARLA  
(smiling, easy)  
Well, then. You'll be on my list  
too.  
(beat)  
That's a joke.

She goes. The door closes.

Arianna sits alone. Dee's photograph smiles at her from the corkboard.

She doesn't move for a long time.

CUT TO:

**9 INT. CHILDREN'S HEALTHCARE OF ATLANTA AT EGLESTON –  
PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY PLAYROOM – DAY**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:34 AM EST*

The playroom: primary-colored beanbags, a fish tank, a bookshelf, and paper snowflakes taped to the windows. A handful of KIDS in pajamas and hospital bracelets, some bald, some with IV poles, are gathered on a big alphabet rug.

Marc sits cross-legged on the rug in his navy suit pants and a white shirt with the sleeves rolled up, his jacket thrown over a tiny chair. In his lap is a hand-bound book. The cover is a child's watercolor of a purple dinosaur wearing a tiara.

KEYONNA (7), bald, fierce, in pink pajamas, sits pressed right up against his knee. DEANDRE (9), in a Falcons jersey over his hospital gown, sits a skeptical foot away with his IV pole beside him.

NURSE TONYA (40s), in cartoon scrubs, leans in the doorway, arms folded, enjoying herself.

MARC

(reading, big voice)

"And the Dinosaur Princess looked at the whole entire Kingdom of Snacks, and she said: 'I am a princess, AND I am a dinosaur, and I do not have to choose.'"

KEYONNA

(triumphant, to  
DeAndre)

SEE?

DEANDRE

That's not a real book.

MARC

It's extremely real. You're looking at it.

DEANDRE

You wrote it.

MARC

I wrote it this weekend. That's what makes it real. Keyonna told me Thursday there aren't any books about dinosaur princesses. So now there's one.

DEANDRE

(pointing at the cover)  
Who drew that?

MARC

(beat)  
I did.

DEANDRE

(flat)  
It looks like a grape with a hat.

The kids CRACK UP. Marc clutches his chest like he's been shot.

MARC

(recovering, back to the book)  
"And the Dinosaur Princess ruled the Kingdom of Snacks for a thousand years, and everyone was allowed to have seconds, and nobody ever had to take medicine that tasted like pennies."

A beat. The kids go quiet at that. They all know medicine that tastes like pennies.

KEYONNA

(small)  
Does she get married?

MARC

The Dinosaur Princess?

KEYONNA

Uh-huh.

MARC

(considering it seriously)  
Only if the prince is funny.

KEYONNA  
Are you funny?

DEANDRE  
No.

MARC  
(to DeAndre)  
I will put you in the sequel as a  
grape.

More laughter. In Marc's pocket, his phone BUZZES. He glances at it. BRIELLE. He lets it buzz.

It buzzes again. GHOST.

He closes the book gently.

MARC (CONT'D)  
Okay. Chapter two Thursday.  
Keyonna gets to name the dragon.

He stands. He gives Keyonna the book. She holds it with both arms like it might escape.

KEYONNA  
I get to keep it?

MARC  
It's yours. You're the princess.

She beams. In the doorway, Nurse Tonya has to look at the ceiling for a second.

**10 INT. EGLESTON – THE HALLWAY OUTSIDE THE PLAYROOM –  
CONTINUOUS**

Marc walks and pulls on his jacket at the same time, phone to his ear.

MARC  
(into phone, quiet)  
Go.

KEISHA (V.O.)  
(filtered)  
Two things. One: our friend at  
Deputy Chief level made another  
phone call from his personal cell  
Saturday night. Eleven-forty.  
Nine minutes. Same WBKG desk.

MARC

The funeral.

KEISHA (V.O.)

That'd be my guess. It led the eleven o'clock. "Rival Gangs Stand Together at Slain Deacon's Funeral." With footage. Somebody told WBKG exactly which church and exactly what time.

MARC

And two?

KEISHA (V.O.)

Italy's done. All four shops. None of them has cut onyx in that pattern, none of them has shipped more than fifty stone discs to anybody in the last two years.

(beat)

Seven shops left. Germany, India, Hong Kong, Israel, South Africa. I'll have Germany by tonight.

(beat)

Tobias found something at Chatham Savings. He wants to show you in person. He says don't make him say it on a phone.

Marc stops walking.

MARC

Tonight. The Table. Nine o'clock.

He hangs up. At the end of the hall, a little bald boy in a wheelchair waves at him. Marc waves back, smiling. The smile drops the second he turns the corner.

CUT TO:

**11 INT. CITY HALL EAST — APD HEADQUARTERS — EVIDENCE ROOM — DAY**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 11:21 AM EST*

A caged basement room. Steel shelving, bar-coded boxes, a long counter under a fluorescent tube that flickers. An APD EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN (50s), sleeves rolled, stands behind the counter with a clipboard.

On the counter: three small plastic evidence bags, each holding one black onyx coin.

Elxa stands on one side of the counter with Jeremy. On the other side, Doyle and Reyes. Doyle holds a folded document with a blue backing.

DOYLE  
Federal Magistrate Carver. Signed  
at eight-fifty this morning.

Doyle sets the order on the counter. Elxa picks it up and reads every line. Then she sets it down.

ELXA  
(to the Custodian)  
Release them. Full chain of  
custody. Photograph the transfer.  
Both agents sign, I sign, you  
sign.

EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN  
Yes, Chief.

The Custodian begins the paperwork. Doyle leans on the counter, watching Elxa.

DOYLE  
You're not going to fight me.

ELXA  
You got a court order. I'm a  
police officer. That's the whole  
relationship.

DOYLE  
(beat)  
Three coins.

ELXA  
Three coins.

DOYLE  
But your command-staff report  
only lists two.

The room gets quiet. Jeremy looks up from his clipboard. The Custodian stops writing.

ELXA  
(evenly)  
How do you know what's in my  
command-staff report?

DOYLE  
Because I read it.

(beat)  
Somebody faxed it to our field  
office Saturday morning. No cover  
sheet. No name.

A long, hard beat. Elxa's jaw sets.

ELXA  
(very quietly)  
From what number?

DOYLE  
A Kinko's on Ponce.

ELXA  
(beat)  
Of course it was.

DOYLE  
(studying her)  
You kept the third coin out of  
your own report. On purpose.

ELXA  
Yes.

DOYLE  
Why?

ELXA  
(beat)  
Because my report leaks.

Doyle holds her look. For the first time, something like  
respect passes between them.

DOYLE  
(quietly)  
So you're running a mole hunt in  
your own building. In your first  
month.

ELXA  
I'm running a murder  
investigation, Agent Doyle. The  
mole is just in the way.

The Custodian slides the transfer form across the counter.  
Doyle signs. Reyes signs. Elxa signs last, hard, the pen  
almost tearing the paper.

Doyle picks up the three bags. She holds the one with the  
seven-crest coin up to the flickering light.

DOYLE  
They don't kill their own  
customers. I said that Friday.

ELXA  
You did.

DOYLE  
I'm starting to think somebody  
wants me to arrest the wrong man.

ELXA  
(beat)  
Then don't.

Doyle pockets the bags. At the cage door she turns.

DOYLE  
Chief. When you catch your mole.  
I'd like to be told before I read  
it in the paper.

ELXA  
When I catch my mole, Agent  
Doyle, you'll read it in the  
paper like everybody else.

Doyle almost laughs. She goes. Reyes follows, giving  
Jeremy a sympathetic two-finger salute.

The cage door CLANGS shut.

JEREMY  
(quietly)  
A Kinko's on Ponce.

ELXA  
He's not even trying to hide it.

JEREMY  
He's not trying to hide it from  
us. He's trying to make sure you  
know he can.

CUT TO:

**12 INT. PHIPPS PLAZA — PARKING DECK — LEVEL 3 — DAY**  
*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 12:02 PM EST*

The neutral ground. Concrete, fluorescent light, a Saks  
delivery truck grinding its gears somewhere below.

The black Range Rover is already parked, engine running. AMOND BAKER (22), in a camel coat and jeans, stands at the open back door, unbuckling LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2) from a car seat. She's in a purple puffer coat and holding a stuffed giraffe by the neck.

The dented silver Honda Civic swings into the space beside him, a little fast. Harmony gets out in a black Keel & Associates blazer with her name badge still clipped on and her cell phone at her ear.

She looks at Amond. He looks at her.

The rules: no talking. Just the child, the bag, and ten minutes. A hundred times.

Amond sets Lyric on her feet. Lyric runs to her mother's knees.

LYRIC  
MAMA! I rode the pony!

HARMONY  
(scooping her up)  
You rode the pony? In January?

LYRIC  
Pony Marc!

HARMONY  
(tight)  
Pony Marc.

Amond takes a small duffel out of the Range Rover and holds it out. Harmony takes it without looking at him. She turns to her car.

AMOND  
She had greens Sunday.

Harmony stops.

AMOND (CONT'D)  
My mother made them. With a lot  
of hot sauce. She ate two  
helpings.  
(beat)  
I thought you'd want to know.

HARMONY  
(beat, not turning  
around)  
Thank you.

She opens the back door of the Civic. She starts strapping Lyric into the car seat. Amond watches her. He doesn't get back in his car.

AMOND

I read the paper.

Harmony keeps buckling.

AMOND (CONT'D)

The Sentinel. Saturday. "New DA Reopens Case of Missing Southwest Atlanta Man." They quoted your LiveJournal.

(beat)

I can help.

Harmony straightens up. She closes the back door of the Civic on Lyric, who's already singing to her giraffe. Harmony turns and faces him.

HARMONY

Help.

AMOND

My company. BSI. We do this. We find people. We've got two hundred investigators on three continents, we've got analysts who can pull every traffic camera, every pawn ticket, every bus pass in this city for the last three years. We've got people who found a kidnapped oil executive in the Niger Delta in eleven days.

(beat)

Give me a week. I'll put the best people I've got on it. It won't cost your family one dime. You'll have—

The SLAP echoes off the concrete like a gunshot.

Amond's head turns with it. Somewhere below, a car alarm starts wailing.

Harmony's hand is shaking. Her eyes are blazing.

HARMONY

(low)

You think money fixes everything?

AMOND  
(holding his cheek,  
stunned)

I—

HARMONY  
Three years. Three YEARS I  
stapled my brother's face to  
telephone poles on Campbellton  
Road in the rain. I called APD  
every Monday for eighteen months  
until the desk sergeant knew my  
voice and hung up on me. My  
mother lit a candle in her front  
window every night for a thousand  
nights. My daddy drives around  
the city on Saturdays looking at  
men sleeping under bridges to see  
if one of them's his son.  
(beat)  
Where was your two hundred  
investigators then?

AMOND  
(quietly)  
I didn't know you then.

HARMONY  
You knew me for ONE NIGHT.

The words hit the concrete and bounce.

Amond takes it. He doesn't touch his cheek again.

HARMONY (CONT'D)  
(voice cracking)  
And now a woman who never met him  
in her life, a woman who's  
twenty-two years old and doesn't  
owe me anything, is looking for  
him because it's her job and  
because it's right. Not because  
she's got a company. Because it's  
RIGHT.  
(beat)  
You don't get to buy that. You  
don't get to show up three years  
late with a checkbook and take my  
brother away from the one person  
who's doing it for free.

AMOND  
(beat)

That's not what I—

HARMONY

Every time, Amond. The Tiffany bag. The lawyers. The pony. Your mother's petition. Everything with your family comes with a price tag or a court date.

AMOND

(quiet, hurt)

My mother withdrew the petition.

HARMONY

Your mother offered to withdraw it for one Sunday a month. That's not withdrawing, that's a counteroffer.

A silence. The car alarm below finally stops.

From inside the Civic, muffled through the glass:

LYRIC (O.S.)

Mama? Daddy? You yelling?

They both turn toward the car. Lyric presses her face and her giraffe to the window, worried.

Harmony pulls herself together in one breath. She smiles at the window, a brilliant, fake, perfect mommy smile, and waves.

HARMONY

(through the smile, not moving her lips much)

Don't ever do that again.

AMOND

(through his own smile, waving at Lyric)

Hit me?

HARMONY

Offer.

She gets into the Civic. She pulls out without looking back.

Amond stands alone in the deck, waving at the taillights until they're gone. Then his hand drops.

He touches his cheek. It's already turning red.

AMOND  
(to nobody)  
Okay.

FADE OUT.



**ACT THREE****13 INT. KEEL & ASSOCIATES REALTY – BUCKHEAD – HARMONY'S CUBICLE – DAY**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 2:14 PM EST*

A beige Buckhead office, forty cubicles under drop-ceiling lights. Harmony's desk is the one nobody wants, next to the restroom door, under the loudest air vent.

Her cubicle wall: a photo of Lyric on the pony, a Northwestern-purple mug of pens, and a FIND DEE flyer. A child's crayon drawing of a giraffe.

Harmony sits flexing her right hand. The palm is still pink.

Her desk phone RINGS. She picks up.

HARMONY

Keel and Associates, this is  
Harmony Divine.

CARLA (V.O.)

(filtered)

Ms. Divine, this is Carla Mims.  
I'm an investigator with the  
Fulton County District Attorney's  
Office, Cold Case Unit. I've been  
assigned your brother's case.

Harmony sits bolt upright.

HARMONY

Yes. Yes, ma'am. Ms. Cummings  
said you'd call.

CARLA (V.O.)

I read Darnell's file this  
weekend. I'd like to come sit  
with you and your parents. At the  
house, if that's all right. I  
find people remember better in  
their own kitchens.

HARMONY

(grabbing a pen,  
knocking the mug of  
pens over)

Yes. Yes. Anytime. Whenever you  
want.

CARLA (V.O.)  
Your mother said anytime but  
Sunday.

HARMONY  
(half laughing, half  
crying)  
Sunday's church.

CARLA (V.O.)  
Sunday's church. How about Friday  
afternoon? Four o'clock?

HARMONY  
(writing it on her  
hand, on her palm, over  
the pink)  
Friday. Four. Yes.

CARLA (V.O.)  
Ms. Divine. I want to be honest  
with you so you don't hear it  
from anybody else. Three years is  
a long time. I can't promise you  
what I'll find.

HARMONY  
(beat)  
Nobody's ever even promised to  
look.

A pause on the line.

CARLA (V.O.)  
(gently)  
Then I'll promise that.  
(beat)  
I've got his picture up on my  
wall already. And one on the  
District Attorney's. I'll see you  
Friday.

The line clicks off. Harmony sits holding the phone.

She looks at the flyer on her cubicle wall. Dee grins  
back.

HARMONY  
(whispering)  
Somebody's looking, Dee.

She hangs up. She wipes her eyes fast with the heel of her  
hand, the one that hit Amond.

Her cell phone BUZZES on the desk. The caller ID reads E.O.S.

She picks up.

HARMONY (CONT'D)  
(into cell)  
I slapped him.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. SMILLEY TOWER – 71ST FLOOR – ESTHER'S OFFICE –  
CONTINUOUS**

An enormous white office with a curved glass wall looking directly across Peachtree Road at Donohue Tower. ESTHER SMILLEY (22) stands at the window in a black Armani pantsuit, phone to her ear. Behind her, on a white lacquer desk, a presentation binder: SMILLEY INTERNATIONAL ATLANTA – REAL ESTATE STRATEGY – CONFIDENTIAL.

ESTHER  
(beat)  
Hello to you too.  
(beat)  
You slapped who?

HARMONY  
Lyric's father. In the Phipps deck. In front of Lyric.

ESTHER  
(beat)  
Did he deserve it?

HARMONY  
(beat)  
I don't know.  
(beat)  
He offered to find Dee.

Esther closes her eyes briefly.

ESTHER  
With his company.

HARMONY  
With his company. His two hundred investigators on three continents.

ESTHER  
(carefully)  
And you said no.

HARMONY  
I said it with my hand.

ESTHER  
(beat)  
Harm. His company is very, very  
good at finding people.

HARMONY  
I don't want him to be good at  
it. I want him to have been  
THERE.  
(beat)  
The DA's investigator called.  
Carla Mims. She's coming to  
Mama's house Friday. She put his  
picture on her wall.

ESTHER  
(softening, then  
briskly)  
Tomorrow. Nine o'clock.  
Seventy-second floor. The navy  
suit.

HARMONY  
Why do I have to be at your board  
meeting?

ESTHER  
(looking out at Donohue  
Tower)  
Because tomorrow morning I'm  
going to make my brother's head  
explode, and I want a witness.

HARMONY  
(laughing despite  
herself)  
You're insane.

ESTHER  
I'm a Smilley. It's genetic.  
(beat, quieter)  
And Harmony? Don't apologize to  
Lyric's father.

HARMONY  
I wasn't going to.

ESTHER

Yes, you were. You were going to call him tonight after Lyric's asleep and say you're sorry.

(beat)

Don't. Let them earn it.

HARMONY

(beat)

You say that about every man.

ESTHER

(eyes on the tower across the street, on one particular window on the 58th floor of the building beyond it that she can't possibly see)

Every man should have to.

She hangs up. She stays at the window.

CUT TO:

**14 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE CATERING KITCHEN – DAY**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 3:04 PM EST*

The Olson Estate's second kitchen, the one built for four-hundred-person fundraisers: stainless steel, a twelve-burner range, and a walk-in cooler. Right now it's a laboratory.

GRACE BULLOCK (20), in a Spelman sweatshirt with her hair wrapped in a silk scarf, stands at the range stirring a double boiler with a wooden spoon. MALLORY OLSON (19), in lab goggles and a Spelman Chemistry T-shirt, weighs brown lumps of raw shea on a digital scale, reading from a green leather notebook propped open against a flour canister.

The TOUSSAINT FORMULARY. S.T., 1931. Handwritten in faded ink.

GRACE

(stirring, bright)

So. Wednesday.

MALLORY

What about Wednesday?

GRACE

Don't "what about Wednesday" me. Velvet. You said you'd come. Lo's got me doing a walk-through with the owner's people about a showcase in March. It's Alvin's club.

MALLORY

Unofficially.

GRACE

Everything Uncle Alvin does is unofficially. That's how you know it's his.

(beat)

There's a new DJ on Wednesdays. Everybody's talking about him. Kiara's friend's sister says he played Minnie Riperton into Kanye and a girl fainted.

Mallory weighs another lump of shea, not looking up.

MALLORY

(beat)

Daddy doesn't like Velvet.

GRACE

Uncle Peter doesn't like anything that happens after ten o'clock that isn't surgery.

Mallory finally smiles. She pushes her goggles up on her head.

MALLORY

Fine. Wednesday. But I'm home by midnight.

GRACE

(grinning)

Sure you are.

Behind them, in the doorway to the main house, MARTIN OLSON (23) leans on the frame in shirtsleeves with a glass of mineral water. Neither girl has seen him.

He's been listening. His eyes are on the green leather book.

MARTIN

(pleasantly)

What's cooking?

Both girls jump. Mallory closes the Formulary.

MALLORY  
Martin! God. Knock.

MARTIN  
It's my kitchen. I grew up in it.  
(strolling in, peering  
at the pot)  
Is that lunch?

GRACE  
It's a secret.

MARTIN  
(smiling)  
My favorite kind.  
(to Mallory)  
You're going out Wednesday?

MALLORY  
(guarded)  
Maybe.

MARTIN  
Velvet. I heard.  
(beat)  
Be careful there, Mal. Uncle  
Alvin's club. Uncle Alvin's  
friends.

MALLORY  
Since when do you care where I  
go?

MARTIN  
(beat, gently)  
I always care where you go. I  
just don't always say so.

He picks up the wooden spoon and sniffs it. His eyes flick  
to the green book under Mallory's hand.

MARTIN (CONT'D)  
Smells expensive.

He sets the spoon down and strolls out. Mallory and Grace  
look at each other.

GRACE  
(quietly)

That was weird.

MALLORY  
(pulling the Formulary  
to her chest)  
Martin's always weird.

GRACE  
He knew about Velvet.

MALLORY  
(beat)  
I didn't tell him.

CUT TO:

**15 INT. BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES, LLP – CAMILLE RHODES'S  
OFFICE – 40TH FLOOR – DAY**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 3:47 PM EST*

A glass-walled corner office in a Peachtree Street tower. Law books, a leather couch, and a framed Georgia Bar certificate: CAMILLE ANTOINETTE RHODES, 1991. A floor-to-ceiling window over Midtown.

Camille sits at her desk in a dove-gray suit, reading a brief with a red pen.

Her assistant's voice over the intercom:

ASSISTANT (V.O.)  
Ms. Rhodes. Mrs. Bullock is here.

Camille looks up. The red pen stops.

CAMILLE  
(beat)  
For Mr. Bullock?

ASSISTANT (V.O.)  
Mr. Bullock is in the Hendricks  
deposition until five. She says  
she'll wait with you.

A beat. Camille caps her pen.

CAMILLE  
Send her in.

The door opens. Natasha enters in the ivory St. John suit and a camel coat over her arm, with a small white box from Henri's Bakery. She's radiant, relaxed, and lethal.

NATASHA

Camille. I'm so sorry to drop in.  
I was downtown for the Chamber  
board and I thought I'd surprise  
Robert with a late lunch.  
Apparently he's surprising  
someone named Hendricks instead.

CAMILLE

(standing, gracious)  
Natasha. What a nice surprise.  
Please.

They air-kiss. Natasha holds the moment one half-second  
longer than necessary, cheek to cheek.

Then she steps back and sets the bakery box on the desk.

NATASHA

Cheese straws. From Henri's.  
Robert's favorite. You'll share  
them with him, won't you?

CAMILLE

Of course.

Natasha sits on the leather couch without being asked and  
crosses her legs. Camille sits in the chair across from  
her.

A beat. Camille smiles back.

NATASHA

(pleasantly)  
Six years, now? That you've been  
with the firm?

CAMILLE

Fourteen, with the firm. Six as  
senior partner.

NATASHA

Fourteen. Goodness. You were a  
baby.

CAMILLE

I was twenty-four.

NATASHA

My daughter's age.  
(beat)  
Twenty-four is a very young age  
to start anything.

The words land. Camille doesn't flinch.

Natasha tilts her head, as if noticing something for the first time. She breathes in, delicately.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

Oh. You're wearing it today.

CAMILLE

(beat)

Wearing what?

NATASHA

Smile. The Smilley fragrance.  
Tuberose. A little green. A  
little vetiver underneath, like a  
secret.

(beat)

I noticed at Marc's birthday you  
weren't wearing any perfume at  
all. I told you it was  
considerate.

CAMILLE

(evenly)

You did.

NATASHA

And now you are.

CAMILLE

It was a gift.

NATASHA

From whom?

CAMILLE

(beat)

A client.

NATASHA

A generous client. Four hundred  
dollars an ounce.

(beat)

Was it a Smilley? They're so  
generous right now. They're  
sending gifts all over town.

CAMILLE

It was a client, Natasha. I don't  
discuss clients. Privilege.

NATASHA  
(delighted)  
Of course. Privilege.  
(beat)  
Robert's very big on privilege.

She rises. She picks up her camel coat. Camille rises too.

NATASHA (CONT'D)  
I won't wait after all. Tell  
Robert I stopped by.

CAMILLE  
I will.

NATASHA  
(at the door, turning)  
And Camille?

CAMILLE  
Yes?

NATASHA  
(sweetly)  
It's a lovely scent. But it's  
very strong.  
(beat)  
It gets into everything.  
Upholstery. Car seats.  
(beat)  
Collars.

She walks out. The door closes behind her with a soft click.

Camille stands perfectly still.

Slowly, she sits down behind her desk. She looks at the white bakery box.

She opens it. Cheese straws, neatly lined up.

And tucked inside the lid, a small cream card, engraved N.D.B., with a single line in Natasha's elegant hand:

INSERT – THE CARD: "Enjoy them. You've already had everything else of his."

Camille closes the box.

Her hand, on the lid, is trembling.

FADE OUT.



## ACT FOUR

**16 INT. RAVENHURST – LUCIUS'S STUDY – DUSK**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 5:21 PM EST*

Ravenhurst, the Smilley estate on the edge of Belmont Crest. The study is dark wood, green leather, and a fire. Oil portraits of Cornelius and a young Odessa. A crystal decanter of scotch.

LUCIUS SMILLEY (55), Chairman and CEO, still in his suit, sits behind his desk. He's trying to sign a stack of documents with a heavy gold pen.

His right hand shakes. The signature comes out ragged.

He switches the pen to his left hand, flexes his right, and tries again. It's worse.

VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49), elegant in black cashmere, stands at the fire with a glass of wine. She's been watching.

VIVIENNE  
(quietly)  
Stop.

LUCIUS  
I'm fine.

VIVIENNE  
You've signed your name three times, and it looks like three different men.

LUCIUS  
(snapping)  
Then I'll sign it four times.

VIVIENNE  
(setting down her glass)  
Lucius.

She crosses to him. She takes the pen out of his hand, very gently. His hand keeps trembling in the air, as if it's still holding it.

He stares at his own hand.

LUCIUS  
(very low)

It's worse in the afternoon.

VIVIENNE

I know.

LUCIUS

It was only in the mornings in October.

VIVIENNE

I know, darling.

She sits on the edge of the desk beside him and takes his shaking hand in both of hers. She holds it still.

VIVIENNE (CONT'D)

Wednesday. Two o'clock. Emory. Dr. Harrington. He's the best movement-disorder man in the South. He trained at Johns Hopkins.

LUCIUS

If it's what we think it is.

VIVIENNE

Then we'll know. And then we'll decide.

LUCIUS

(beat)

Desmond can't know.

VIVIENNE

Desmond is having dinner with someone Wednesday night. He told his assistant to clear his calendar. He's too busy counting his own votes to watch your hands.

LUCIUS

Odessa knows.

VIVIENNE

Odessa knows everything. She just prices it.

(beat)

She's known since October. She hasn't said a word. That means she's waiting to see what it costs.

LUCIUS

And Esther?

Vivienne's hand tightens around his.

VIVIENNE

Esther saw it at the dinner table  
last week. She looked away.

(beat)

She looked away for your sake.

LUCIUS

(beat)

She's the only one of them who  
would.

VIVIENNE

She's the only one of them who's  
ours.

Lucius closes his eyes.

LUCIUS

Tomorrow she's going to walk into  
that boardroom and hand our  
entire Atlanta real-estate book  
to a girl who sells condos in  
Lindbergh.

VIVIENNE

I know.

LUCIUS

Luke's going to go through the  
ceiling.

VIVIENNE

I know.

(beat)

Are you going to back her?

LUCIUS

(opening his eyes)

She's my heir.

(beat)

If my hand shakes while I raise  
it, you'll tell me.

VIVIENNE

(quietly)

It won't shake.

LUCIUS

How do you know?

VIVIENNE

Because I'll be sitting next to you. And I'll be holding it under the table.

She lifts his trembling hand and kisses the back of it.

VIVIENNE (CONT'D)

(standing, crisp again,  
the CEO's wife)

Oh. And Delphine called from the Buckhead store. Somebody in the Donohue family is making beauty products.

LUCIUS

(beat)

Which somebody?

VIVIENNE

She doesn't know yet. But a shea cooperative in Kumasi called Delphine's buyer to ask why an American girl was asking about "Toussaint shea."

(beat)

Toussaint, Lucius.

LUCIUS

Simone Donohue's maiden name.

VIVIENNE

(picking up her wine,  
looking into the fire)

In 1976 I offered that woman two million dollars for her formulas. She sent me back a jar of rose balm.

(beat)

I still have it. I've never opened it.

CUT TO:

**17 INT. DONOHUE TOWER — MARTIN'S OFFICE — 86TH FLOOR —  
NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 6:09 PM EST*

Martin's office: black glass, black leather, and a single white orchid. A view down Peachtree to Smilley Tower, lit up in gold.

On the wall, a bank of four TVs. On one of them, WBKG's six o'clock news replays Saturday's funeral footage again. The two rows of men. Silas and Mama Dee on the steps, arm in arm.

Martin stands in front of the screen with his hands in his pockets.

MARTIN  
(to the TV, softly)  
Holding hands.

On the desk, a small pile of printouts: Celeste Vaughn's courthouse counts, marked up in red. A battered paperback of The Prince sits on the credenza, dog-eared, its spine cracked white.

His desk phone. Not the office line. A second phone, black, with no display. He picks it up and dials a long number from memory. International.

He waits. Then:

MARTIN (CONT'D)  
(into phone, pleasant)  
It's me.  
(beat)  
It's after midnight there, I know. I thought you'd still be up. You never sleep before the tables close.  
(listening)  
They buried him Saturday.  
(beat)  
Together. Merriweather's men on the left, and his on the right. The old woman from the restaurant walked in on Silas Merriweather's arm. It led every newscast in the city.  
(listening)  
Yes. There's a nephew. Theodore. They call him Teddy.  
(a small smile)  
I thought you'd like that.  
(listening)  
Young. Hungry. Thinks his uncle's gotten soft. He stared across the church hall at the Mayfield boy

the whole repast.

(beat)

That's where it breaks. Not with Silas. With the young ones. Old men make truces. Young men don't honor them.

(listening)

No. Not yet. I'm not calling anyone yet.

(beat)

I'm having dinner Wednesday with a man who has the same problem I have.

(listening)

Smilley. The brother.

(beat)

Because his niece is the heir, and he holds sixteen votes out of a hundred. He needs friends to stop her. Or debts.

(listening, then quietly)

Yes. I understand.

(beat)

I remember what you told me. "Never make a man an ally. Make him a creditor. Allies leave."

(beat)

Good night.

He hangs up. He sets the black phone in the desk drawer and locks it.

He looks back at the TV. The footage has moved on to the weather.

He picks up a red pen and walks to a whiteboard on the wall, hidden behind a sliding lacquer panel. He slides it open.

On the board, in Martin's neat handwriting, a list:

INSERT — THE WHITEBOARD:

"1. MERRIWEATHER — TEDDY?

2. APD — HUGHES (leaking. Good.)

3. FBI — DEEP WATER (Savannah)

4. SMILLEY — DESMOND (Wed. 9 PM, Ritz)

5. ROBERT — C. RHODES (since '99?)"

He picks up the red pen. He draws a circle around "ROBERT." Twice.

He caps the pen. He slides the panel shut.

MARTIN (CONT'D)  
(to himself, pleased)  
Everybody's so busy.

CUT TO:

**18 INT. BELLE RIVE – THE FAMILY DINING ROOM – NIGHT**  
*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 6:52 PM EST*

Not the formal dining room. The family one, off the kitchen: a round walnut table for six, a chandelier on a dimmer, and French doors onto the dark terrace. Nana Ruby's pot roast steams in a Le Creuset in the middle of the table, with rice, gravy, and green beans.

Robert sits at the head, loosened tie, in a good mood. Grace, still in her Spelman sweatshirt, sits to his left, talking with her hands. Natasha sits at the foot, in a cream silk blouse, serving the plates.

Ruby moves in and out of the kitchen door with rolls.

NATASHA  
I stopped by the firm after.

A tiny beat. Robert keeps cutting.

ROBERT  
Did you? I was stuck in Hendricks all afternoon.

NATASHA  
Camille told me. I sat with her a while.

ROBERT  
(beat)  
That was nice of you.

NATASHA  
It was nice of her. She's very gracious.  
(beat)  
And she smells wonderful.

Grace, reaching for a roll, doesn't catch any of it.

GRACE

Camille always smells good. At  
the Christmas party she smelled  
like a Nordstrom.

Robert laughs a little too loudly. Natasha lifts her water  
glass.

NATASHA

(to Grace)

What else did you girls make  
today?

GRACE

Rose balm. Batch one. It's not  
right yet. Mal says the shea's  
too young. But Mama, listen, this  
is the weird part.

(leaning in)

Somebody called the co-op in  
Kumasi before we did. Asking  
about Toussaint shea. Mal called  
three times. The lady won't say  
who. She just says "an American  
woman, very polite, very rich."

NATASHA

(beat)

Very polite, very rich.

GRACE

Who even knows about Kumasi?  
Grandma Simone kept that book in  
a drawer since 1946.

NATASHA

(evenly)

Vivienne Smilley.

Robert's fork stops.

GRACE

(beat)

Who?

NATASHA

Vivienne Smilley. She tried to  
buy those formulas from your  
great-grandmother in 1976.  
Through a lawyer in Paris. Two  
million dollars.

(beat)

Grandma Simone sent her a jar of  
rose balm and a note that said  
"No, thank you."

GRACE  
(stunned)  
The perfume lady?

NATASHA  
The perfume lady.

GRACE  
The SMILE lady?

NATASHA  
(sipping her water,  
eyes on Robert)  
The Smile lady.

Robert sets down his fork. He picks up his wine.

ROBERT  
Well. That's the Smilleys. They  
want everything we've got.

NATASHA  
(beat)  
Don't they.

Ruby, coming through the kitchen door with the gravy boat,  
stops for half a second in the doorway. Then she comes in  
and sets it down in front of Robert.

RUBY  
More gravy, Mr. Robert.

ROBERT  
Thank you, Ruby.

RUBY  
(pleasantly)  
You're gonna need it.

She goes back into the kitchen. Grace looks from her  
father to her mother.

GRACE  
(slowly)  
Is something going on?

ROBERT AND NATASHA  
(together)  
No, baby.

They look at each other down the length of the table.

Grace, twenty, a pop star, not stupid, picks up her roll and chews very slowly.

FADE OUT.



**ACT FIVE****19 INT. RAVENHURST – THE NURSERY – NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 7:44 PM EST*

A fairy-tale nursery: pale-pink walls hand-painted with a Parisian carousel, two white canopy beds, and a rocking horse with a real horsehair mane. A night-light shaped like a crescent moon.

EMMA SMILLEY (2) and VICTORIA SMILLEY (2), in matching yellow pajamas, sit on the rug in front of a little easel covered in paper and fat crayons. NANNY BEA PENNINGTON (43), Norland-trained, cardigan and sensible shoes, sits in a rocking chair with her knitting.

Esther, still in her work clothes with her shoes off, kneels on the rug between her daughters.

Victoria has been drawing very seriously with a brown crayon. She holds up her paper: a big round face with enormous teeth, a huge scribbled grin, and two dots for eyes.

VICTORIA

Mama. Funny man.

Esther freezes.

ESTHER

(carefully)

Who's that, Dividend?

VICTORIA

(pointing at the

drawing, insistent)

FUNNY man.

And then she laughs. Her big, loud, delighted, head-thrown-back laugh.

That laugh.

In the rocking chair, Bea's needles stop clicking.

ESTHER

(quietly)

Where did you see the funny man, baby?

VICTORIA  
(pointing at the  
window)  
Outside!

Esther looks at the window. Beyond it, across the dark lawn, over the tall hedges, the lights of Belmont Crest glitter on the ridge.

BEA  
(gently, going back to  
her knitting)  
She sees him on the television,  
Miss Esther. The Bullock boy. He  
was on the news last week,  
carrying food off an airplane in  
Sri Lanka, and then on the local  
program with his birthday cake.  
Miss Victoria stands right up to  
the screen.  
(beat)  
She has the most discerning taste  
in comedians.

Esther doesn't turn around.

ESTHER  
(evenly)  
She's two, Bea. Everything's a  
funny man.

BEA  
(knitting)  
Of course, Miss Esther.

A knock at the doorframe. ODESSA SMILLEY (84) stands there, silver-haired and ramrod straight, in a dark-plum dressing gown, leaning on an ebony cane with a gold handle.

ODESSA  
Is there room for an old woman in  
the land of ponies?

EMMA  
GIGI!

The twins scramble up and throw themselves at Odessa's knees. She plants her cane and bends, with great ceremony, to kiss the tops of both their heads.

ODESSA

Beatrix. Take the ladies for  
their bath. I need a word with  
their mother.

BEA

(rising)

Yes, Madame Smilley. Come along,  
my darlings. Bath time. Bubbles.

TWINS

BUBBLES!

Bea herds them out. As she passes, Victoria reaches back  
for her drawing. Esther holds it out of her reach with a  
smile.

ESTHER

I'll keep it safe for you.

The door closes. Odessa lowers herself into the rocking  
chair with a small sigh. Esther stays kneeling on the rug,  
holding the drawing.

ODESSA

Tomorrow, your uncle will say  
nothing at all. He'll sit there  
and let Luke and Delphine bleed  
on the table, and afterward he'll  
count who bled.

(beat)

Desmond is having dinner with  
someone Wednesday night.

ESTHER

(looking up)

With whom?

ODESSA

I don't know yet. That's what  
worries me. I always know.

A beat. Odessa rocks.

ODESSA (CONT'D)

Your father will vote with you.

ESTHER

I know.

ODESSA

Do you know why?

ESTHER  
Because I'm his heir.

ODESSA  
Because he's frightened, and  
you're the only one of his  
children who doesn't frighten  
him.  
(beat)  
That's not the same thing as  
love, but in this family it's the  
closest thing we've got.

Esther looks down at the drawing in her hands. The big,  
grinning face.

ODESSA (CONT'D)  
(watching her)  
What's that?

ESTHER  
(beat)  
Victoria's art.

ODESSA  
Let me see.

Esther hesitates, then holds it up. Odessa looks at it for  
a long moment.

ODESSA (CONT'D)  
(dryly)  
A man with a great many teeth.

ESTHER  
She calls him "Funny man."

ODESSA  
(beat)  
Does she.

Odessa rocks once. Twice.

ODESSA (CONT'D)  
Esther. You've been to that gate  
twice in one week.  
(off Esther's look)  
Mr. Crowe reports to your father.  
Your father tells your mother.  
Your mother tells me everything,  
because she's afraid of me.

ESTHER

(beat)

Mrs. Donohue invited me.

ODESSA

She invited you once. You went twice.

(beat)

And both times you turned around.

Esther rises from the floor. She folds the drawing in half, then in half again, and slips it into the pocket of her trousers.

ESTHER

(evenly)

I told you last week. I'm not afraid of Simone Donohue.

ODESSA

(beat)

No, darling. I believe you.

(beat)

I've never once seen you afraid of an old woman.

She lets that sit. Then she rises on her cane, and pats Esther's cheek on her way to the door.

ODESSA (CONT'D)

Wear the gray tomorrow. Red is for parties. Gray is for war.

She goes. Esther stands alone in the moonlit nursery.

From down the hall, the sound of splashing, and then Victoria's laugh again.

Esther closes her eyes.

CUT TO:

**20 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD – BLACKWATER TASK FORCE  
FLOOR – NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 8:26 PM EST*

The half-unpacked task force floor. The whiteboards have grown: LAMAR WHITLOCK, EARL TUGGLE, the traffic-cam still of the white van, the burned-out van in Clayton County.

A new section: SATURDAY – THE FUNERAL. A row of surveillance photographs taken by APD's own long lens: the

Merriweather men on the left side of the stairs, the other men on the right.

Elxa stands in front of the board with a marker. Jeremy sits on a desk eating Chinese food out of a carton.

She ignores him. She pins up a new photo: Silas Merriweather stepping out of his Cadillac, offering his crooked left hand back into the car.

Then another: the woman in the black hat and veil taking that hand.

ELXA  
Dolores Whitfield.

JEREMY  
(chewing)  
Mama Dee.

ELXA  
Fifty-three. Owns Dee's Kitchen  
on Ralph David Abernathy since  
1981. No record. Not even a  
parking ticket. Widowed in 1975.  
(beat)  
Silas Merriweather buried him.  
For free.

JEREMY  
That's a nice story.

ELXA  
It's a thirty-year story.  
(beat)  
And on Saturday, twenty  
Merriweather men and twenty men  
nobody can name straightened  
their backs when she got out of  
that car.

Jeremy sets down his carton.

JEREMY  
Elx.

ELXA  
I know.

JEREMY  
She's a church lady who makes  
pies.

ELXA

Every one of those men looked at  
her before they looked at Silas.

(beat)

Jeremy, I've been looking for  
Blackwater in the wrong places.  
I've been looking for a man in a  
black car. Maybe I should've been  
looking at who everybody looks  
at.

She takes a marker and writes under Mama Dee's photo:  
"WHITFIELD - ???"

Then, under the photos of the unnamed men on the right  
side of the steps, she writes: "WHO ARE THEY?"

She stands back. Jeremy comes up beside her.

JEREMY

(quietly)

The FBI shot the same pictures.

ELXA

I know.

JEREMY

Doyle wrote down the restaurant.  
I saw her do it through the  
windshield.

ELXA

(beat)

Then we'd better get there first.

Jeremy looks at Mama Dee's photograph. The veil. The calm.

JEREMY

My mama eats at Dee's every  
Sunday after church.

ELXA

So does half this city.

JEREMY

(beat)

That's what I'm afraid of.

Elxa caps the marker.

CUT TO:

**21 EXT. BELMONT CREST — THE RIVER GATE — NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 8:59 PM EST*

The black Chattahoochee, running high and cold. No moon.  
The iron lantern over the boathouse door.

One by one, down the bluff path, a few minutes apart: Mama Dee with a covered dish. Saint. Roman. Tobias with a leather portfolio instead of his laptop. Keisha with her hood up. Amond, the handprint on his cheek faded to a pink shadow.

Two knocks each.

**INT. THE RIVER GATE BOATHOUSE — THE TABLE — CONTINUOUS**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 9:04 PM EST*

The black-lacquered Table. The iron chandelier and its candles. The river moving beneath the floorboards.

Seven chairs filled. The Eighth, at the far end, empty, its black velvet seat catching the candlelight.

Marc at the head, in a black sweater. Sovereign.

Mama Dee uncovers a dish: peach cobbler. She starts spooning it into bowls.

MAMA DEE

Eat first.

SAINT

(already reaching)

Then we'll talk about who needs  
to disappear.

MAMA DEE

(slapping his hand  
lightly with the spoon)

Don't you steal my line, Rashad.

A ripple of laughter. Amond doesn't laugh. Marc sees it.  
He lets it go.

MARC

Mama Dee. The funeral.

MAMA DEE

(sitting, folding her  
hands)

It went the way it was supposed  
to go. Twenty and twenty, both

rails. Nobody spoke, nobody  
touched, nobody even spat.  
Reverend Peavy preached the  
deacon home. Saint gave Bernice  
the mortgage.

MARC

And Silas?

MAMA DEE

(beat)

Silas says he'll be patient. A  
Merriweather kind of patience. It  
runs out on a Tuesday, and it  
doesn't tell you on the Monday.

(beat)

He has a nephew. Teddy. His  
sister's boy. Twenty-six, maybe.  
Nice suit, no sense. He stared a  
hole through Saint all through  
the repast.

SAINT

He wanted me to say something.

MARC

Did you?

SAINT

I ate a chicken wing at him.

ROMAN

(quietly, the first  
thing he's said)

That's the break point.

Everybody looks at Roman.

ROMAN (CONT'D)

Not Silas. Silas is sixty. Silas  
has made his peace with how the  
world is. Teddy's twenty-six.  
Somebody who wants a war doesn't  
go to the general. He goes to the  
lieutenant who thinks the  
general's gone soft.

MARC

(beat)

Saint. Put somebody on Teddy.  
Somebody he won't notice. I want  
to know who he eats with.

SAINT

Done.

MARC

Ghost.

KEISHA

(sliding a single sheet  
into the middle of the  
table)

Germany's clear. Both shops. One  
of them makes gravestones in  
Idar-Oberstein and hasn't taken a  
foreign order since the Wall came  
down.

(beat)

Five left. India, two. Hong Kong.  
Israel. South Africa.

(beat)

And our deputy chief called WBKG  
at eleven-forty Saturday night.  
The funeral. Then somebody faxed  
the Chief's command-staff report  
to the FBI field office from a  
Kinko's on Ponce. Saturday  
morning.

MARC

(beat)

And Elxa?

KEISHA

She knows it's him. She just  
can't prove it. Thursday she's  
going to try.

MARC

(very quietly, almost  
proud)

She'll get him.

Mama Dee glances at him. She's the only one who catches  
the note in his voice.

MARC (CONT'D)

Tobias.

Tobias doesn't open the portfolio right away. He puts both  
hands flat on it.

TOBIAS

Chatham Savings and Trust.  
Founded 1919. Two branches, both  
in Savannah. Four hundred and  
twelve accounts. Old shipping  
families, port pilots,  
stevedoring companies, a couple  
of judges. The kind of bank where  
the president still sends a  
Christmas ham.

(beat)

The Fed shipped them eight  
hundred thousand in new hundreds  
on December sixth. Standard  
currency order. On December  
ninth, sixty thousand of it  
walked out the door as a cash  
withdrawal from one commercial  
account.

(beat)

Twenty thousand ended up in Lamar  
Whitlock's savings account the  
next morning.

ROMAN

And the other forty?

TOBIAS

Don't know yet.

MARC

Whose account, Tobias?

Tobias opens the portfolio. He takes out one sheet, a  
photocopy of a signature card, and slides it down the  
table to Marc.

TOBIAS

(evenly)

Harbour Point Logistics, LLC. A  
customs brokerage and  
freight-forwarding company in  
Garden City, Georgia. Right  
outside the port.

(beat)

It's a wholly owned subsidiary of  
Donohue Shipping.

Silence. The river moves under the floor.

Saint's chair comes down on four legs.

MARC  
(very still)  
Say that again.

TOBIAS  
Harbour Point Logistics is owned  
by Donohue Shipping. Donohue  
Shipping is owned by Donohue  
Enterprises. Donohue Enterprises  
is owned by DGH.  
(beat)  
The money that paid Lamar  
Whitlock came out of your  
family's company, Marc.

Nobody moves. Keisha looks at the table. Mama Dee looks at  
Marc. Amond looks at the signature card.

AMOND  
Who signed for the withdrawal?

TOBIAS  
Chatham's a hundred-year-old  
bank. The teller's slip says  
"Authorized Agent" and a scrawl.  
The authorized signers on the  
account are the company's  
president, a man named Gerald  
Pettaway, who's seventy-one and  
has been in a nursing home in  
Pooler since August—  
(beat)  
—and "such other agents as the  
parent company may designate in  
writing."

ROMAN  
So anybody at Donohue Shipping.

TOBIAS  
Anybody at Donohue Shipping who  
has a letter on DGH letterhead.

A long, terrible silence.

MAMA DEE  
(quietly)  
Baby.

MARC  
(beat)  
I'm fine.

MAMA DEE

I didn't ask if you were fine. I  
said baby.

Marc picks up the signature card. He looks at it. He sets  
it down very precisely, squared to the edge of the table.

MARC

(evenly)

This stays at this table. Nobody  
outside these seven chairs.

(beat)

Not Arianna. Not the General. Not  
my family.

TOBIAS

Understood.

MARC

Tobias. I want every Harbour  
Point transaction since the day  
Donohue Shipping bought it. Every  
wire, every withdrawal, every  
customs filing. And the other  
forty thousand.

TOBIAS

Yes.

MARC

Roman. I want to know who at  
Donohue Shipping can write a  
letter on DGH letterhead. Every  
name. Quietly. Nobody in Savannah  
knows we asked.

ROMAN

Yes.

MARC

Ghost. Keep going on the shops. I  
want the one that made those  
coins.

KEISHA

You'll have it this week.

MARC

Saint. Teddy.

SAINT

Done.

MARC

Mama Dee.

MAMA DEE

Yes, baby.

MARC

Tell Silas the proof is coming.

(beat)

And tell him that when I find the  
man who did this, he's going to  
be very surprised whose name is  
on him.

Mama Dee holds his eyes a long time. Then she nods.

MARC (CONT'D)

Amond. Stay.

The others rise. They go one by one. Keisha squeezes  
Marc's shoulder on the way past, which she never does.  
Saint takes two bowls of cobbler with him. Mama Dee pauses  
at the door.

MAMA DEE

(to Marc)

Whoever it is. Blood or no blood.

MARC

Blood or no blood.

She goes. The door closes. Just Marc and Amond now, and  
the Eighth Chair.

AMOND

(not sitting down)

Harmony Divine hit me today.

MARC

(looking at the pink  
shadow on his cheek)

I can see.

AMOND

I offered to find her brother. A  
team. Ghost's analysts, Roman's  
people, traffic cams, pawn  
tickets. She said I think money  
fixes everything.

(beat)

It's the one thing we're actually  
good at, Marc. We found the  
Delgado girl in Juárez in four

days.

MARC  
Don't put BSI on it.

AMOND  
Why not?

MARC  
Because she said no. And because  
the DA's office has a GBI veteran  
on it now. Forty of our operators  
knocking on the same doors as a  
Fulton County investigator isn't  
help, Mond. It's obstruction.  
(beat)  
And the DA is Ari.

AMOND  
(beat)  
Since when do you care about  
obstruction?  
(beat)  
Saint says your car was parked on  
Northside Drive Friday night.

The candles gutter.

MARC  
Saint talks too much.

AMOND  
Saint never talks. That's why I  
noticed.

MARC  
Ari had a bad night. She called  
me. I went.  
(beat)  
That's the whole story.

AMOND  
(beat)  
Okay.

MARC  
You said okay like a man who's  
going to go look.

AMOND  
(beat)  
Maybe I am.

MARC  
(quietly)  
Mond. I'm asking you. As your  
brother.  
(beat)  
Not as Sovereign. As your  
brother. Don't put anybody on Dee  
Divine.

A very long beat. The two of them look at each other  
across eighteen years of friendship and one secret.

AMOND  
(finally)  
You've never had to ask me as  
your brother before.

MARC  
I know.

AMOND  
That's how I know it's bad.

He picks up a bowl of cobbler. He walks to the door. He  
stops with his hand on it.

AMOND (CONT'D)  
(without turning  
around)  
I won't put anybody on it.  
(beat)  
But she's the mother of my  
daughter, Marc. And if I find out  
that whatever you're not telling  
me is going to hurt her—  
(beat)  
Then we're going to have a very  
different conversation. Not as  
brothers.

He goes. The door closes.

Marc sits alone at the head of the Table. He looks down  
the length of it at the Eighth Chair.

MARC  
(quietly, to the empty  
chair)  
It's getting harder to fill the  
ones I've got.

FADE OUT.



**ACT SIX****22 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE LIBRARY — NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 — 10:14 PM EST*

The library. The fire burns low. The quilt and pillow are folded neatly on the end of the Chesterfield. Night five.

Victor sits in his armchair in his pajamas and silk robe. Anna Karenina lies face down on his knee. He isn't reading it. He's looking at the fire.

A soft knock. The door opens. Marc slips in, still in the black sweater, holding a foil-covered plate.

MARC

(low)

Room service.

VICTOR

(not turning)

If that's from your grandmother,  
tell her I've been fed.

MARC

It's not from Grandma.

(setting it on the side  
table, peeling back the  
foil)

It's from Mama Dee's. Peach  
cobbler.

Victor looks. He looks for a long time.

VICTOR

(beat)

Dee's Kitchen.

MARC

You used to take me there on  
Saturdays after the barbershop.  
Before you had a driver.

VICTOR

I always had a driver. I just  
didn't take him to the West End.  
(picking up the fork,  
taking one bite,  
closing his eyes)  
God help me.

MARC

Good?

VICTOR

Your grandmother is going to know.

MARC

How? She's asleep.

VICTOR

Your grandmother has been married to me for forty-five years. She'll smell it on me at breakfast.

MARC

(sitting on the arm of the Chesterfield)

Then she'll know somebody loves you.

Victor almost smiles. Then he sets the fork down.

VICTOR

You didn't come here with cobbler at ten o'clock at night because you missed me.

MARC

I did miss you.

VICTOR

And?

Marc looks at the fire.

MARC

Harbour Point Logistics.

Victor's face doesn't change. That's how Marc knows he's heard the name before.

VICTOR

(evenly)

A customs brokerage in Garden City. Donohue Shipping bought it in 1998. The old man who ran it, Gerald Pettaway, had no sons, and he didn't want the Maersk people to have it. He came to me personally. We paid him more than it was worth, and we let him keep

his office.  
(beat)  
It files paperwork on the  
Savannah containers. Customs  
declarations. Bonds. It's the  
least interesting company we own.  
(beat)  
Why?

MARC  
Curiosity.

VICTOR  
(sharply)  
You've never been curious a day  
in your life. You're either  
certain or you're asleep.

A beat. Marc meets his eyes.

MARC  
The FBI file. Operation Deep  
Water. It names Donohue Shipping.  
The Port of Savannah.

VICTOR  
Your grandmother told me.

MARC  
If somebody's using Harbour  
Point—

VICTOR  
(cutting him off)  
If somebody is using my company,  
I'll know by Friday.

MARC  
Granddaddy—

VICTOR  
(rising, the robe  
falling around him like  
a king's)  
Marc-Anthony. I ran this company  
for thirty years. I have been  
Chairman for nine more. I know  
the name of every man who has  
ever signed a Donohue check over  
a hundred thousand dollars. I  
know which of them drink, which  
of them pray, and which of them  
have a second family in

Tallahassee.

(beat)

If someone is using my ships, my  
port, or my paper, I will know  
who by Friday.

(beat)

And on Saturday, they won't work  
anywhere on this earth again.

Marc looks up at him. Sixty-eight years old in pajamas,  
and absolutely nobody to trifle with.

MARC

(quietly)

Yes, sir.

VICTOR

(sitting again, picking  
up the fork)

And you won't tell me why you  
asked.

MARC

No, sir.

VICTOR

(beat, eating cobbler)

Good. I've decided not to ask.

(beat)

Remember what I told you on your  
birthday.

MARC

"Carry it like a Donohue."

VICTOR

Like it weighs nothing.

(beat)

You're not doing a very good job  
tonight.

Marc laughs, low, and it's real. He stands. He kisses the  
top of his grandfather's head, which he hasn't done since  
he was a boy.

MARC

Two more nights.

VICTOR

Two more nights.

Marc goes to the door.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Marc.

Marc turns.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

(not looking up from  
the cobbler)

Tell Dolores Whitfield the crust  
is better than it was in 1994.

MARC

(beat, careful)

I'll tell her.

He goes. Victor eats alone by the fire.

He sets down his fork. He picks up the phone on the side  
table. He dials four digits from memory. An internal line.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

(into phone)

Winston. I'm sorry to wake you.

(beat)

Call Donohue Shipping's general  
counsel at home. I want him in my  
office at seven o'clock tomorrow  
morning. With the Harbour Point  
file.

(beat)

No, Winston. Not Martin. Just the  
counsel.

(beat)

Thank you.

He hangs up. He picks the book back up.

Somewhere far down the hall, a woman's footsteps pass the  
library door and pause. Joan. Then they keep going.

CUT TO:

**23 INT. THE CUMMINGS ESTATE – 41 KINGSRIDGE DRIVE –  
ARIANNA'S BEDROOM – NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:37 PM EST*

Arianna's childhood bedroom, which she has never moved out  
of. Law books on shelves beside debate trophies. A Spelman  
pennant. A window seat overlooking the dark garden and the  
white gazebo.

Arianna sits on the floor of her walk-in closet in a Spelman T-shirt and sweatpants, surrounded by open shoeboxes.

She's looking for something.

In one box, she finds it. A stiff, cream-colored invitation, printed in gold:

INSERT – THE INVITATION: "Dr. and Mrs. Walter Henderson request the pleasure of your company to ring in 2002. December 31, 2001. Nine o'clock until the new year. 3244 Northside Drive NW. Black tie."

She reads it. She turns it over. On the back, in her own handwriting, nineteen-year-old loops: "Designated driver = ME!!! (lol)"

She stares at it.

Slowly, she presses the invitation to her mouth. She shakes silently.

Then she sets it back in the shoebox. She puts the lid on. She puts the shoebox on the top shelf of the closet, all the way in the back, behind her old debate trophies.

She stands. She turns off the closet light.

On her nightstand, her cell phone lights up. A text message. From MARC:

INSERT – THE TEXT: "sleep. i've got it."

She looks at it for a long time.

She doesn't answer. She lies down on top of the covers with her eyes open.

CUT TO:

**24 INT. BELLE RIVE – NATASHA'S STUDY – NIGHT**

*Monday, January 10, 2005 – 10:48 PM EST*

A jewel-box study off the master suite: peacock-blue walls, a Louis XV writing desk, framed photos of Natasha with three presidents, and Alexander's portrait over the mantel. A single lamp burns.

Natasha sits at the desk in a silk robe. In front of her, on the blotter, lies a flat white Hermès box.

She lifts the lid. Inside, perfectly folded in tissue, is Robert's white shirt.

She looks at it. Then she replaces the lid.

She picks up the phone. She dials a number from a small leather address book.

It rings twice.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
(filtered, awake  
instantly)  
Greer.

NATASHA  
Nathaniel. It's Natasha Donohue  
Bullock.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Mrs. Bullock. Good evening. Is  
something wrong at one of the  
properties?

NATASHA  
No. Everything's fine at the  
properties. That's why I'm  
calling you and not the police.  
(beat)  
Nathaniel. You're the Director of  
Global Security for Donohue  
Hotels and Resorts. Forty-one  
properties. Nineteen countries.  
(beat)  
I want every reservation made in  
the name of Robert J. Bullock, at  
any Donohue property, anywhere in  
the world, going back to 1999.

A pause on the line.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
(carefully)  
Mr. Bullock. Your husband.

NATASHA  
My husband.  
(beat)  
And every reservation in the name  
of Camille A. Rhodes.  
R-H-O-D-E-S. Same dates. Same  
properties. Any property. Any  
city.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

(beat)

Ma'am. I— With respect, ma'am,  
that's personal information on a—

NATASHA

Every reservation. Every  
room-service ticket. Every late  
checkout. Every time a key card  
was cut for a second guest.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

(quietly)

Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA

And Nathaniel.

(beat)

Going forward, if either of those  
names books a room at any Donohue  
property in the world, I want to  
know before the key card is cut.

(beat)

Not after. Before.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

Yes, Mrs. Bullock.

NATASHA

This is between you and me. Not  
the hotel division president. Not  
my father. Not my husband.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

Understood, ma'am.

NATASHA

Thank you, Nathaniel. Good night.

She hangs up. She sits back.

On the desk, the Hermès box.

Over the mantel, Alexander Donohue looks down at his  
granddaughter from 1965, stern and proud.

Natasha looks up at him.

NATASHA (CONT'D)

(quietly)

You always said we built the  
hotels so we'd never have to be  
turned away at the front desk.

(beat)  
You never said what to do when  
the front desk is the only one  
who knows.

Down the hall, a door opens. Robert's voice, sleepy,  
calling from the master suite:

ROBERT (O.S.)  
Tash? You coming to bed?

Natasha puts the Hermès box in the bottom drawer of her  
writing desk. She locks it with a tiny gold key. She drops  
the key into the pocket of her robe.

NATASHA  
(calling back, warm,  
perfect)  
Coming, baby.

She turns off the lamp.

In the dark, the tiny gold key catches the last of the  
firelight as she walks out.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0006

## NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

— On the 72nd floor of Smilley Tower, ESTHER stands before the board and names her secret weapon: "Harmony Divine will broker every Smilley land deal in Atlanta." LUKE: "Over my dead body." LUCIUS: "Then we'll miss you."

— At Keel & Associates, the whole office goes silent as HARMONY walks back to her cubicle beside the restroom door, now the most envied agent in Buckhead.

— On the 88th floor of Donohue Tower, NATASHA reads the Sentinel's business wire and hands it to VICTOR: "The Smilleys just hired Lyric's mother."

FADE TO BLACK.